

CORPORATE NEWS snippets



Applied Materials planning semiconductors manufacture in India

Applied Materials is in talks with the government of India and planning to set up a plant in the country. If the plan materialises, the United States situated company will soon start setting up a plant here. The company's original plan was for setting up a plant that would manufacture some parts and components used in complex equipment, which in turn are used for manufacturing semiconductor chips across the world. There is no such commercial facility in India till date.

Samsung decides not to go for telecom PLI scheme

Samsung is not participating in the production-linked incentive (PLI) scheme for telecom equipment manufacturing as it is not looking to commit new investments in a market where it has only one client, as per two top executives of the company. Samsung supplies equipment to Reliance Jio for its 4G network along with equipment for the recent 5G trials the latter is doing in India.

VVDN planning to invest in telecom PLI scheme

VVDN Technologies has plans to invest big in the recently announced PLI scheme for telecom gear. Puneet Agarwal, the newly appointed CEO of VVDN, announced that the company's investment will be much larger than what is mentioned in the PLI scheme guidelines. Agarwal, who was made CEO following the untimely demise of Bhupender Saharan, also said that the guidelines of the scheme seem suitable for a company like VVDN.

Nokia and HFCL to participate in telecom PLI scheme

Telecom equipment manufacturers Nokia and HFCL will be partaking in the telecom PLI scheme, the guidelines of which were announced by the Department of Telecommunications (DoT) recently. The PLI scheme, which has a budgetary outlay of ₹121.95 billion, is aimed at turning India into a manufacturing hub for telecom and network equipment. The government expects the scheme to bring in investment of over ₹30 billion and generate tax revenue of about ₹170 billion.

Gujarat's Kevadia to have country's first EV-only area

The country's first electric vehicle (EV)-only area will be developed in Gujarat's Kevadia, the Statue of Unity Area Development and Tourism Governance Authority has said in a statement. The authority said that the area surrounding the 182-metre-tall Statue of Unity in Kevadia in Gujarat's Narmada district will be converted into an electric-vehicles-only area in a phased manner. In the area under the authority, only electric vehicles will be allowed to ply, with the buses made available for tourists also running on battery power instead of diesel.

Hisense to set up TV manufacturing plant in India

Chinese consumer electronics brand Hisense has said that it will be setting up a local TV manufacturing plant in India and expand its product portfolio with more launches this year. Hisense has not yet disclosed location of the plant and the amount which it is going to invest here. It is looking to extend its production capacity to two million units within the next two years. The company entered India with a licence arrangement with Videotex last year.

Bharti Airtel's OneWeb applies for satcom licence

Bharti Enterprises backed OneWeb has applied for a global mobile personal communication system licence. If obtained, the licence will allow OneWeb to provide satellite broadband services. The move has come at a time when telecom operators and technology players are deliberating over the rules of satellite

communication spectrum. The discussions include whether satellite communication spectrum should be auctioned or allocated on an administrative basis.

Harman sets up 5G testing lab in India

Samsung-owned Harman has started a 5G testing lab in India. The company aims to provide 5G testing services to organisations to test their devices for operating them on 5G. Harman's testing lab will simulate a 5G radio and core network to measure multiple levels of end-to-end application performance. The lab will first assess radio output, testing frequency, signal quality and modulations, which will be followed by measuring data throughout application layers to assess the output of specific use cases like VR, video, and more.

Amara Raja Batteries to invest in Li-ion batteries

Battery manufacturer Amara Raja Batteries Ltd announced energy and mobility as its strategic focus going forward to capitalise on emerging opportunities, adding that it will invest in new green technologies. The company announced the expansion of the lead-acid batteries business and the establishment of a New Energy SBU encompassing lithium cell and battery pack, EV chargers, energy storage systems, advanced home energy solutions, and related products and services.

Mouser Electronics and T Works to set up prototyping facility

Mouser Electronics Inc. has entered into a partnership with T Works, an initiative by the Telangana government, to support what will be India's largest hardware prototyping centre in Hyderabad. The company said that the new 7,800 square-metre, state-of-the-art prototyping facility will be equipped with over 250 industry-grade tools such as 3D printers, CNC machines, laser cutters, and PCB fabrication to enable MSMEs, startups, and individual innovators to convert their ideas into products more efficiently and economically.

Reliance Jio and Qualcomm to manufacture 5G equipment locally

Reliance Industries has announced that its subsidiary Reliance Jio and Qualcomm Technologies have partnered together to locally manufacture critical equipment to provide momentum to India's 5G ecosystem and adoption. Qualcomm also invested \$97 million in Jio platforms last year. The American chipmaker had also collaborated with Jio to develop open and interoperable interface compliant architecture based 5G solutions with a virtualised RAN.

OnePlus looking to strengthen manufacturing in India

OnePlus is looking to increase investments to strengthen local manufacturing in the country, according to Founder and CEO Pete Lau. The company has seen 200% year-on-year growth in the fourth quarter of 2020 in the country, following the launch of the Nord in July last year, added Lau. OnePlus is investing ₹10 billion over three years to expand its India research and development centre, which will become its largest research facility globally by 2022.

Space-tech startup Agnikul Cosmos raises \$11 million

Agnikul Cosmos Pvt Ltd, a space-tech startup incubated in IIT Madras, has raised \$11 million in a Series A funding round. The startup is currently working on building Agnibaan. Once complete, Agnibaan will be known as India's first private small satellite launch vehicle. It is a rocket that enables plug-and-play configuration and is capable of carrying up to 100kg payload to low earth orbits. The rocket comes with the ability of full customisation as per needs of the customers. Agnikul Cosmos expects to complete its first mission in 2022.